mention bearer tokens or bearer authentication.

Now you know what a token is, as well as how they're issued by identity providers using the OpenID Connect and OAuth 2.0 protocols. Before we get to some code in section 25.3, we'll see what a typical authentication flow looks like for an ASP.NET Core API app using JWT bearer tokens for authentication.

At a high level, authenticating using bearer tokens is identical to authenticating using cookies for a traditional app that has already authenticated, which you saw in figure 25.1. The request to the API contains the bearer token in a header. Any middleware before the authentication middleware sees the request as unauthenticated, exactly the same as for cookie authentication, as shown in figure 25.8.